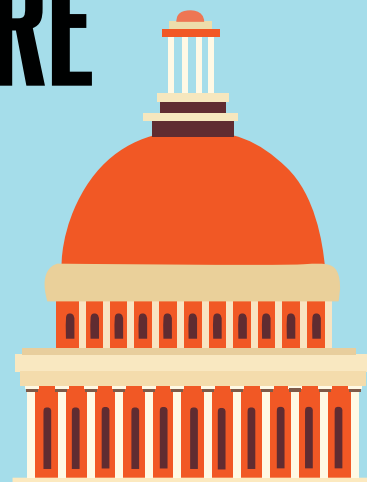


THE STATE OF WELFARE

Social sector spending by states has risen steadily over the past decade, led mainly by bigger states with high own-tax revenues. Many state governments are now increasingly relying on cash transfer, especially through women-focused schemes. While welfare coverage has improved, limited revenues are reducing the funds available for development and infrastructure projects. Here is what the data shows:

By **PRINCE TYAGI**

Graphics By **RAJ VERMA**



MAJOR CASH TRANSFER SCHEMES FOR WOMEN

MAHARASHTRA, KARNATAKA, AND WEST BENGAL ALLOCATED THE MOST. MONTHLY BENEFITS RANGE FROM ₹833 TO ₹2,500

State	Scheme Name	Monthly Benefit (₹)	Budget Provision (BE FY26) (₹ crore)
Maharashtra	Mukhyamantri Majhi Ladki Bahin Yojana	1,500	36,000
Karnataka	Gruha Lakshmi Yojana	2,000	28,608
West Bengal	Lakshmir Bhandar Scheme	1,200	26,700
Madhya Pradesh	Mukhyamantri Ladli Behna Yojana	1,250	18,669
Tamil Nadu	Kalaingar Magalir Urimai Thogai	1,000	13,807
Jharkhand	CM Maiya Samman Yojana	2,500	13,363
Odisha	Subhadra Yojana	833	10,145
Bihar*	Mukhyamantri Mahila Rojgar Yojana	10,000*	7,500
Chhattisgarh	Mahtari Vandan Yojana	1,000	5,500
Delhi	Mahila Samridhhi Yojana	2,500	5,110
Assam	Orunodoi Scheme	1,250	5,000
Haryana	Lado Lakshmi Yojana	2,100	5,000
Himachal Pradesh	Indira Gandhi Pyari Behna Sukh Samman Nidhi	1,500	138

*INITIAL ONE-TIME TRANSFER OF ₹10,000 EACH, SCOPE OF ADDITIONAL FINANCIAL SUPPORT OF UP TO ₹2 LAKH SUBSEQUENTLY

SOURCE PRS, PIB

